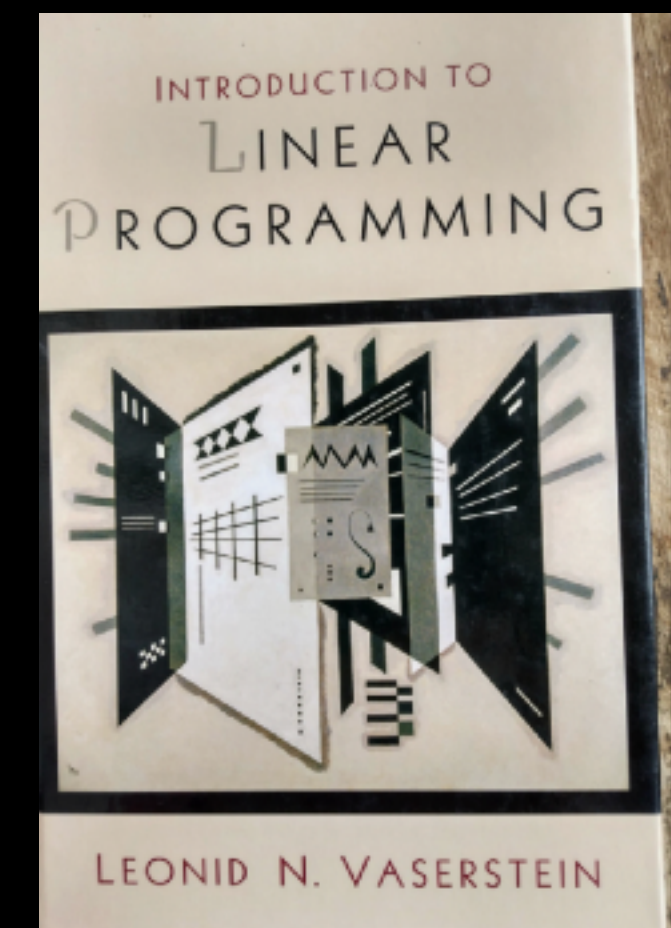
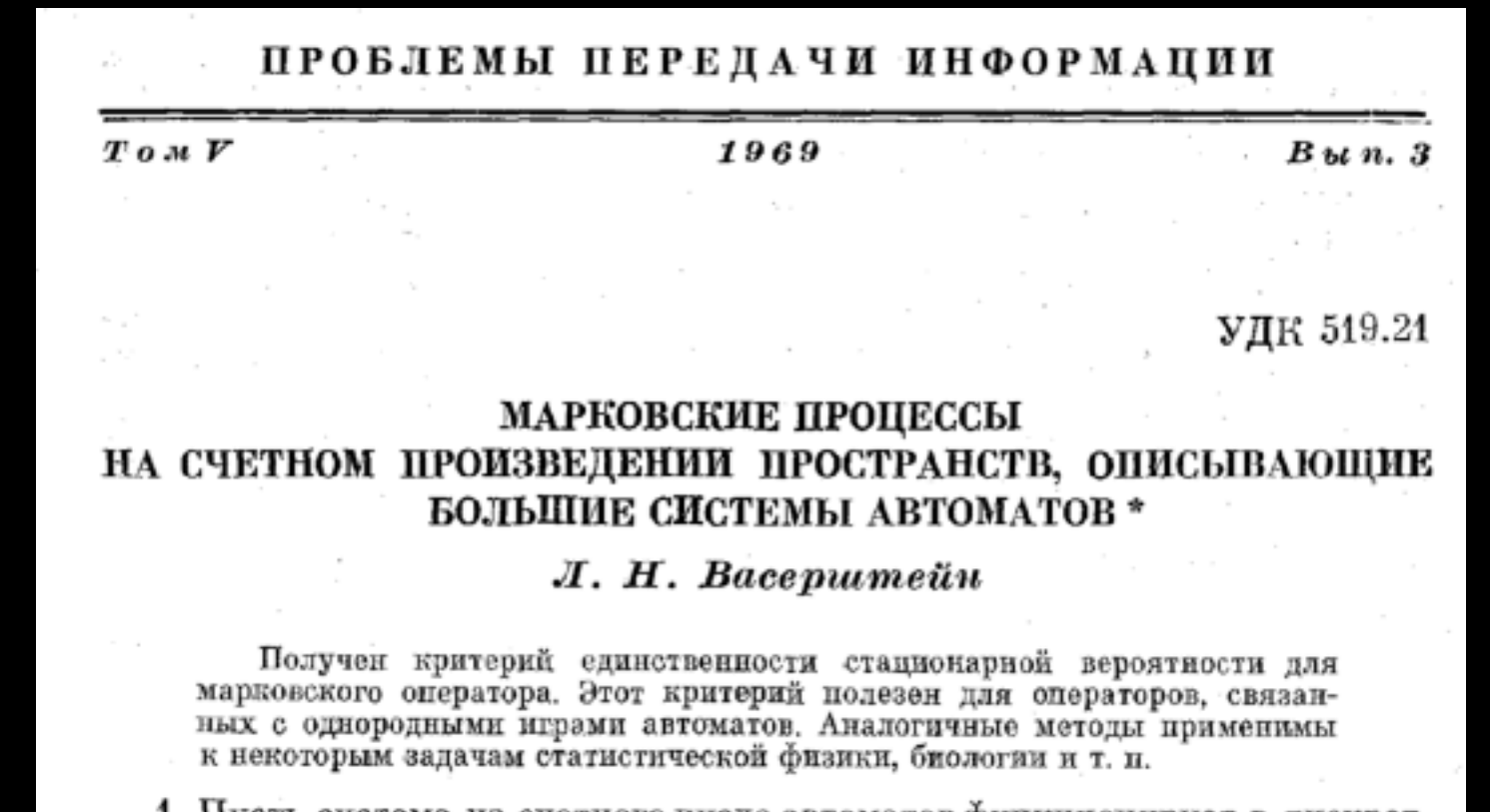


Leonid Wasserstein (Васерштейн)



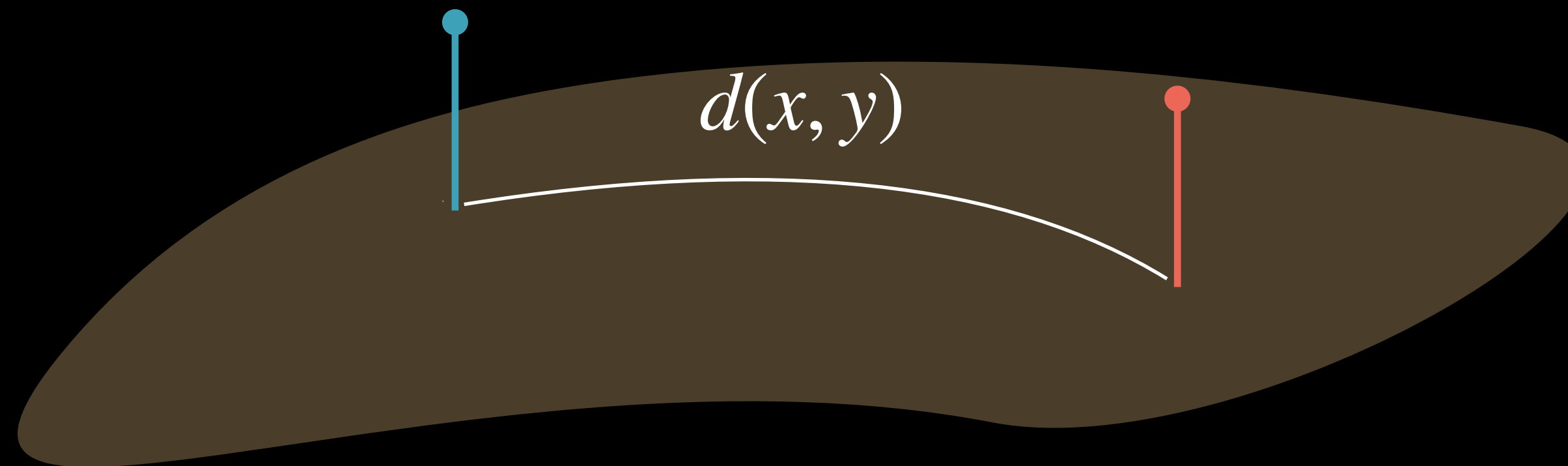
- Also written: Vaseršteĭn, Vasershtein
- Soviet mathematician born in Kharkiv
- Specialized in algebra, K-theory, group theory
- Longtime professor at Penn State
- 1969: introduced the metric on probability distributions that now bears his name, as a tool for functional analysis
- Legacy: Wasserstein metric became a cornerstone concept linking probability, analysis, and geometry.



Example: Diracs

$$\alpha = \delta_x$$

$$\beta = \delta_y$$



$$W_p(\alpha, \beta) = \left(\inf_{\pi \in \Pi(\alpha, \beta)} \int_X d(x, y)^p \, d\pi(x, y) \right)^{1/p} \rightarrow$$